

My Salon Suite: Email and Booking Domain Setup

What we are asking IT to add, why it is set up this way, and exactly what changes for the people receiving the emails.

The short version

The leasing system sends email on your behalf: tour confirmations, reminders, nurture sequences and member onboarding. For those emails to land in inboxes rather than spam, the receiving mail providers need proof that the system is authorised to send as My Salon Suite.

That proof is a small set of DNS records. We are putting them on a **subdomain** of `mysalonsuite.com` rather than on the main domain itself. The rest of this sheet explains why that is the right call, and it is not only convention: your main domain is currently one step away from a technical limit that adding us to it would break.

Why a subdomain instead of `mysalonsuite.com`

1. Your main domain is at 9 of its 10 permitted lookups

SPF is the record that lists who is allowed to send email as your domain. The standard caps it at **10 DNS lookups**. Go past that and the record is treated as broken, and mail providers can begin failing or distrusting mail from the domain.

The record on `mysalonsuite.com` today authorises three senders:

- Google Workspace, for staff mail
- Salesforce and Pardot
- Mailchimp

Between them they already consume **9 of the 10** available lookups. Adding this platform to that same record needs four more, taking it to **13**. That would push the record past the limit, and the consequence would not be limited to the leasing emails: staff mail, Salesforce and Mailchimp all authenticate through that one record.

Putting the leasing system on its own subdomain gives it a **separate SPF record with its own fresh budget**, and leaves your existing one untouched.

2. Sending reputation stays separated

A newly activated automated sender starts with no reputation at the mailbox providers and has to earn one. If it sends from the main domain, every bounce or spam complaint from a leasing sequence attaches to the same domain reputation as your invoices, staff email and Salesforce campaigns.

On its own subdomain that reputation is built and contained separately. If a sequence ever performs badly, corporate mail is unaffected.

3. It is additive and fully reversible

Every record is scoped to the subdomain only. Specifically, this setup does **not**:

- change or replace your existing MX records, so Google Workspace mail routing is untouched
- edit your existing SPF record

- change your DMARC policy
- affect any existing address at @mysalonsuite.com

The MX records in the list below apply *only* to the subdomain, and exist so that bounce and reply handling works for the sending service. Deleting the subdomain records at any point returns everything to exactly its current state.

Does it still look like My Salon Suite to the recipient? Yes. The sender name shown in the inbox is *My Salon Suite Blaine*, and the address underneath sits on your own domain rather than a third party one. Because the subdomain belongs to `mysalonsuite.com`, it also aligns correctly under your existing DMARC record, so it will report cleanly alongside your other senders.

What changes for the person receiving it

Three things become visibly My Salon Suite instead of visibly third party.

What	Today, without these records	After the records are added
The address the email comes from	A generic address on the sending platform's own domain	<code>stacey@mn.mysalonsuite.com</code> , shown as <i>My Salon Suite Blaine</i>
Links inside the email (links are wrapped so opens and clicks can be reported on)	Hovering a link shows a third party tracking domain	Hovering a link shows <code>email.mn.mysalonsuite.com</code>
The tour booking page	<code>api.leadconnectorhq.com/widget/booking/...</code>	<code>book.mysalonsuite.com/...</code> The CNAME makes the address available. We then build the booking page on it, so the link you send a prospect is a My Salon Suite address end to end.

Replies are handled separately from all of this. A reply goes to whichever monitored mailbox you nominate, normally the site leader's own @mysalonsuite.com address, so nobody has to watch a new inbox.

The subdomain label, and why this one. The label is `mn`, giving `mn.mysalonsuite.com`.

It is deliberately scoped to Minnesota. `mysalonsuite.com` is the national domain, so a generic label such as `mail` would read as one region claiming the brand's mail subdomain, and that is a fair thing for corporate to question. A regional label asks for nothing beyond Minnesota's own operations, touches no record any other region or the corporate marketing stack relies on, and gives corporate a pattern any other region could reuse rather than a one-off exception.

The mechanism itself is already in use on this domain: `go.mysalonsuite.com` points at Act-On on its own subdomain, for exactly the same deliverability reason.

The friendly half of the address is set inside the platform and needs no DNS work, so it can change at any time. Our proposal is that emails show as *My Salon Suite Blaine* from `stacey@mn.mysalonsuite.com`, with replies going to Stacey's existing @mysalonsuite.com mailbox so there is no new inbox for anyone to watch.

The records for IT

Three separate items. **Item 1 is required for launch.** Items 2 and 3 are branding improvements: neither blocks go-live, but both are single records and cheapest to add while the zone is already open.

Item 1: Email sending subdomain (required)

Standard email authentication records, scoped to the `mn` subdomain.

#	Type	Host / Name	Value	Priority
1	TXT (SPF)	<code>mn</code>	<code>v=spf1 include:spf.leadconnectorhq.com include:mailgun.org ~all</code>	—
2	TXT (DKIM)	<code>pic._domainkey.mn</code>	<i>see the block directly below this table</i>	—
3	CNAME (tracking)	<code>email.mn</code>	<code>mailgun.org</code>	—
4	MX	<code>mn</code>	<code>mx1.mailgun.org</code>	10
5	MX	<code>mn</code>	<code>mx2.mailgun.org</code>	10

Record 2 (DKIM), full value. One unbroken string. Copy from here rather than from the table above, and paste it as a single line with no spaces or line breaks introduced.

```
k=rsa; p=MIGfMA0GCSqGSIb3DQEBAQUAA4GNADCBiQKBgQCgEBv1S1iAN1xRrB/rdNfRfjAICXJzf6gcVfB3GGm6nnSXY6YPiPXpQekKJQNb02+fqbThWsc5Yp01N13FBn00Tskij+gM6qCG+0c2zzJvWh3nMLBo2T7urMXi/Ekh42ZMqOp99QQE6MGeBjBVLRhPV0tH7H8NfhGCinF2bDIL8wIDAQAAB
```

Note on the Host column: values are relative to the `mysalonsuite.com` zone, so `mn` means `mn.mysalonsuite.com`. If your DNS panel requires fully qualified names, append `.mysalonsuite.com` to each Host. The DKIM value in record 2 is a single unbroken string on one line, and its host uses the `pic` selector exactly as shown.

Item 2: Branded booking subdomain (recommended)

So booking and calendar links sent to prospects carry a My Salon Suite address rather than the platform's default one.

#	Type	Host / Name	Value
6	CNAME	<code>book</code>	<code>sites.ludicrous.cloud</code>

Item 3: Branded landing page subdomain (recommended)

Why: the page a stylist reaches from an ad is the first My Salon Suite thing they ever see, and it currently sits on a third party web address. This points a My Salon Suite address at it instead. It is the most visible of the three items, and the only one a prospect reads before deciding whether you are worth their time.

#	Type	Host / Name	Value
7	CNAME	<code>blaine</code>	<code>mysalonsuite.netlify.app</code>

Once this record is live, let us know and we complete the connection and issue the security certificate on our side. Nothing further is needed from IT, and the certificate is automatic and free.

What we need back

1. The records above added to the `mysalonsuite.com` zone. If it is easier to split the work, records 1 to 5 are the ones that unblock launch; records 6 and 7 can follow.
2. A short note once they are in, so we can run verification on our side. Propagation is usually well under an hour.

Any questions on any record, reply and we will take it directly with your IT team.